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Task 8
Malware fundamentals

Malware Fundamentals

Objective

To understand malware classification and study major malware categories and their typical effects.

Malware Comparison Table

Malware Type	Description	How It Works / Spreads	Typical Effects
Virus	Malicious code that attaches to a file or program.	Spreads when an infected file is shared or executed.	Corrupts files, slows systems, and may damage data.
Worm	Self-replicating malware that does not need to attach to another file.	Spreads automatically through networks or vulnerable systems.	Consumes system/network resources and spreads rapidly.
Trojan	Malware that pretends to be legitimate software or a useful file.	Tricks users into installing or opening it.	Can steal data, provide unauthorized access, or download other malware.
Spyware	Malware that secretly monitors users and collects information.	May enter through malicious software, websites, or downloads.	Can steal passwords, browsing activity, and personal information.

Ransomware	Malware that blocks access to files or systems, usually by encrypting data.	Often spreads through phishing emails, malicious links, or vulnerable systems.	Makes files inaccessible and can cause financial and data loss.
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Conclusion

Malware is malicious software designed to harm systems, steal information, gain unauthorized access, or disrupt operations. Viruses, worms, trojans, spyware, and ransomware have different methods and effects. Understanding these malware types helps users identify threats and follow proper cybersecurity practices.

Interview Questions

1. What is malware?

Malware is malicious software designed to damage systems, steal information, gain unauthorized access, or disrupt normal operations.

2. What is a trojan?

A trojan is malware that disguises itself as legitimate or useful software to trick a user into installing or running it.

3. How is a worm different from a virus?

A worm can self-replicate and spread automatically across networks, while a virus normally attaches itself to a file or program and requires the infected file to be executed.